



FLIP THROUGH BEFORE YOU DOWNLOAD

Vibe Code Your Own Game - The Long Road

Three real pages, straight off the shipping files,
plus everything the full download includes.



Why not a quiz with a health bar

The obvious classroom game is a quiz with points bolted on. It is obvious because it is easy, and it is weaker than it looks.

What a quiz with points actually does

The student has exactly one input: pick the right answer. There is no plan, no trade, no reason to think past the next box. Two students playing the same set have the same experience. **And bolting a score on top can reduce interest rather than raise it** — the reward becomes the point, and the content becomes the toll you pay for it.

What a choice does instead

Put a decision *before* the question and everything changes. Now the student is weighing: do I take the hard pass because we need the supplies, or the low trail because we are running thin? **The thinking happens before they have even seen the question**, and it continues after, because the outcome changes what they choose next.

And the difficulty solves itself

In this game the **player chooses the difficulty for themselves**. No hidden algorithm, no labeling anybody. The student who wants the hard run takes the hard trail; the student who needs a gentler run takes the low trail; both are playing the same game at the same time. Neither has been told which one they are.

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The test to apply to any game you build: if two students with the same content would see the same sequence of screens, **there is no choice in your game** and you have built a worksheet that beeps.

The loudest moment belongs to the student who was wrong

If you take one thing from this pack into your teaching and never build a game at all, take this.

What the research says, in one line

Of the three things that drive motivation — feeling capable, having a say, and belonging — **feeling capable is the strongest**. And the evidence on gamified classrooms is blunt about the rest: points and badges lift interest and enjoyment but do **almost nothing for how capable a student feels**.

So the game celebrates the right thing

A score says *you were already good*. That is news to nobody, least of all the student who was not.

Fixing something you got wrong says: you are better than you were twenty minutes ago. That is competence, it is visible, and it is the one thing a worksheet can never show a child.

How it is built, mechanically

Every question is tagged with an **idea**. Miss it, and that idea **blazes red** on your map — you can see it, you can go around it, and it is waiting. Come back and answer it, and the crossing opens permanently, with the biggest celebration in the game. The map **blazes green** because the student learned something.

This is also just good teaching

Bringing a missed idea back later rather than immediately is spacing, and it is one of the best-evidenced things in learning science. You are not decorating a quiz. You are building the thing the research says works, and making it visible.

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Fixing one opens the road, loudly

The most important twenty lines in this pack.

PROMPT 8 • THE FIX

When the player answers a washed-out crossing correctly: **remove that idea from the missed list, add it to mastered, and show a full-screen celebration** — the only one in the game. It says the road is open, names the idea, and says they turned back here before. Give it the longest sound in the game. **Also**, when they fix a missed idea anywhere else, make that loud too: a big floating "FIXED", the same sound, and a line saying they have just put right what they got wrong. **Nothing else in this game gets a full screen. Not arriving, not a good run, nothing.**

Why this and nothing else

Because **what a game celebrates is what it teaches students to value**. Celebrate speed and they rush. Celebrate a score and they learn that being good at it already is the thing. **Celebrate a fix and you have told every child in the room that getting better is the point** — and the ones who needed to hear that are the ones who got the best first.

The measure the game reports

Not a score. "Ideas locked in", which only shows up at the end, how many of them were put right after getting them wrong. That score is the one worth reading out.

What not to add, however tempting

No leaderboard with names. No visible per-student score. Nothing that lets the room work out who cost them what. **Public ranking harms the students you built this for**, and it is the easiest thing in the world to add by accident.

Task 9 ends when

You miss one on purpose, go back, fix it, and the celebration feels slightly bigger than you expected. That is correct.

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WHAT IS INSIDE

Vibe Code Your Own Game - The Long Road

- ✓ **Choice before question** - the road decides what it asks
- ✓ **Missed ideas block the road** until you go back and fix them
- ✓ The only full-screen moment belongs to fixing a mistake
- ✓ **No way to lose** in front of the class, and no ranking
- ✓ Twelve prompts in full, including what to forbid
- ✓ The finished game included, played three ways

Running it with your whole staff? Additional teacher licenses are just \$11, and we accept purchase orders through TpT for Schools.

